BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Jack Monroe

Private investigator · **43**



CHARACTER

A former detective with a frayed conscience, a stubborn instinct for the truth, and a history with the Ray family.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Salt-and-pepper dark hair, worn brown tweed jacket, open charcoal shirt, dark trousers and scuffed shoes.

CONTINUITY

Carries sunflower seeds, never a lollipop. After Tick shoots his thigh, the wound persists and Jack does not walk again in the film.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Vera Voss

Bookkeeper · **Late 30s**



CHARACTER

Corn's sharp-eyed bookkeeper knows where the numbers are buried, and what she has done to protect herself.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Dark bob, fitted chocolate-brown suit, cream blouse, leather heels and a ledger kept close.

CONTINUITY

Her handwriting gives away the tip to Harriett. She admits the rigged clock and leaves her own pages in the ledger.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Etta Ray

Mother and witness · 52



CHARACTER

Bug and Peanut's mother; dignified, warm and fiercely unwilling to let her son's death be dismissed.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Short natural hair touched with gray, gold hoops, burgundy wrap dress, dark cardigan and practical heels.

CONTINUITY

Etta keeps the ledger and copies, and publicly names Tick, Pike and Kellerman. Her composure never erases her grief.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Bug Ray

Young recordist · **15**



CHARACTER

Etta's observant younger son, always listening for a rhythm and carrying his shoebox recorder.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Short natural hair, denim jacket and jeans, plain T-shirt, canvas sneakers and a portable cassette recorder.

CONTINUITY

A kid, not an adult. His final dryer rhythm is made with physical tape splicing and a dubbed loop, not a sampler; Peanut's laugh comes first.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Peanut Ray

Laundry worker · **19**



CHARACTER

Etta's older son is funny, kind and handsome; his laugh and a small piece of paperwork outlive him.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Short rounded Afro, brown leather jacket, earth-toned collared knit, dark jeans and worn shoes.

CONTINUITY

He folds laundry in the cold open. Bug's tape preserves his laugh and the voice of the man with the gold pinky ring.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Harriett

Community organizer · 30s



CHARACTER

A Panther organizer who feeds neighborhood children and weighs the cost before she sends people into danger.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Full natural Afro, dark leather coat, burgundy turtleneck, high-waisted dark trousers and sturdy boots.

CONTINUITY

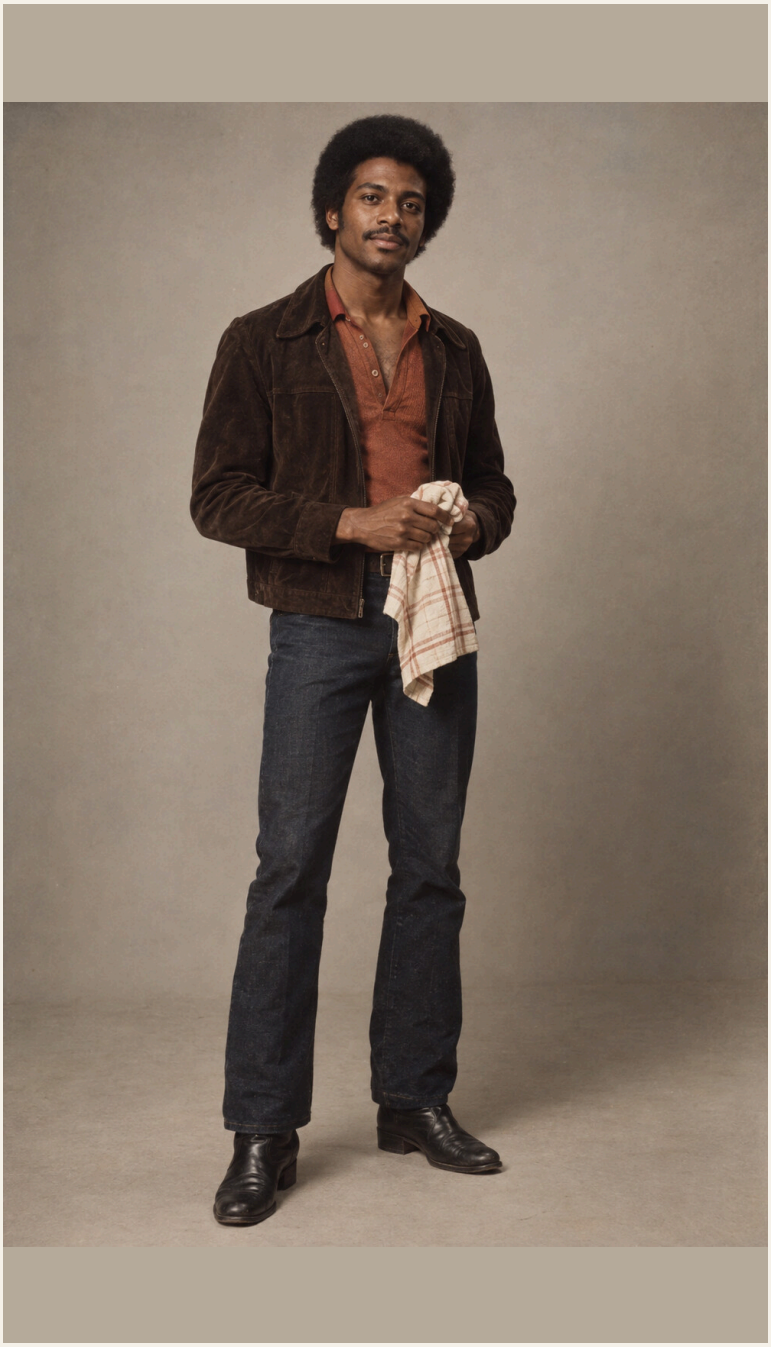
Vera sends her into a rigged clock. Harriett counts her people, confronts Vera, and takes the sealed dope to the Hudson.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Dove

Panther volunteer · **20s**



CHARACTER

Harriett's protective, skeptical colleague, just as comfortable making sandwiches as questioning a dangerous tip.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Rounded natural Afro, brown suede jacket, rust knit shirt, dark jeans and black boots.

CONTINUITY

He is shot in the shoulder during the warehouse fight and wears a sling afterward.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Cornelius “Corn” Brandt

Fixer and bookkeeper · 60s



CHARACTER

Sal's careful fixer hires Jack, keeps the dangerous ledger close and trusts figures more than people.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Slicked-back silver hair, dark checked three-piece suit, patterned tie, polished shoes and a slim ledger.

CONTINUITY

Jack gives Corn's payment to Etta. Corn dies looking for the shoe he lost, without a poetic last line.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Lt. Frank Pike

Police lieutenant · **50s**



CHARACTER

A patient, corrupt officer who uses his authority to keep the paper trail and its witnesses under control.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Close-cut gray hair, open dark overcoat, rumpled detective's suit and a loosened wide tie.

CONTINUITY

He shoots Tick to silence him, panics in the gunfight, then faces an investigation and gives up his badge.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Tick Lane

Dealer and enforcer · 40s



CHARACTER

A guarded dealer whose visible gold pinky ring connects him to the voice on Peanut's recording.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Dark wavy hair, long dark coat, black shirt, leather gloves and a distinctive gold pinky ring.

CONTINUITY

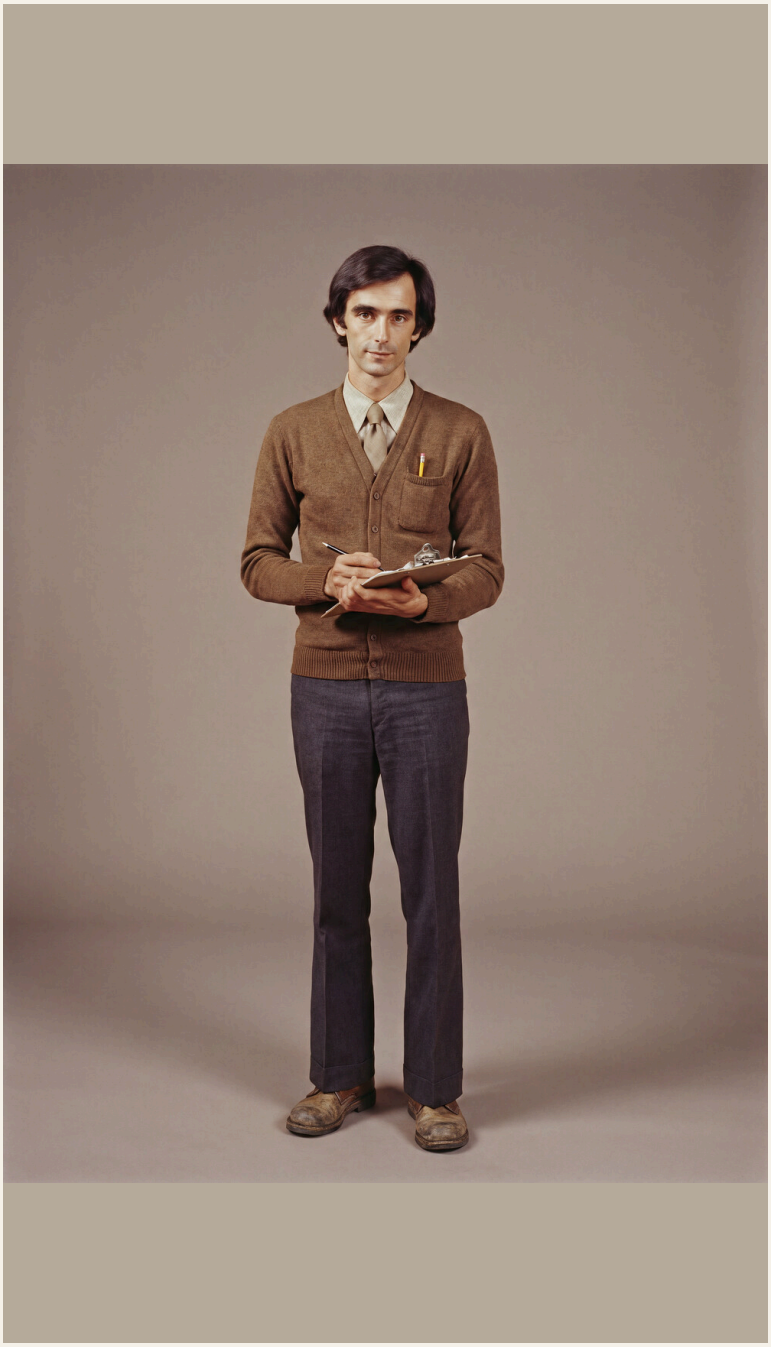
He shoots Jack, is gut-shot by Pike and dies slowly reaching for the recorder. Keep the ring consistent with the opening glimpse.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Nicky

City auction clerk · Adult



CHARACTER

A precise, conscientious clerk who keeps his records straight even when the room is coming apart.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Soft dark hair, brown cardigan, collared shirt and tie, pencil, clipboard and neatly pressed trousers.

CONTINUITY

He is procedural, not a stutterer. He keeps logging the gunfight until a stray round kills him.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Whitney Kellerman

Deputy commissioner · 50s



CHARACTER

The city property official whose impressive seal makes a criminal transfer look like ordinary paperwork.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Neat graying hair, dark three-piece suit, patterned tie, ink-marked cuff and oversized wood-handled stamp.

CONTINUITY

He hides under the table, cuts his hand and later faces questioning; the stamp becomes evidence.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Clutch

Queens biker · **Adult**



CHARACTER

A big man with a soft face who came to the auction for a pinball machine and got caught between everyone else.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Broad build, dark beard, weathered leather vest, work shirt, dark jeans, boots and a plain cap.

CONTINUITY

The Spirit of '76 flyer and pinball machine identify him. He is the innocent bystander killed in the warehouse.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK · 1975

Sal Vetrano

Crime boss · **Older adult**



CHARACTER

Corn's employer, a watchful presence at the coffee shop whose people are waiting at the warehouse.

WARDROBE / LOOK

Salt-and-pepper hair, dark blazer, cream waistcoat, open-collared shirt and an espresso cup.

CONTINUITY

Sal's crew is part of the warehouse deal; Corn handles his books and is the one who hires Jack.

VOTED CASTING REFERENCE
FICTIONAL STORYBOARD DRAFT